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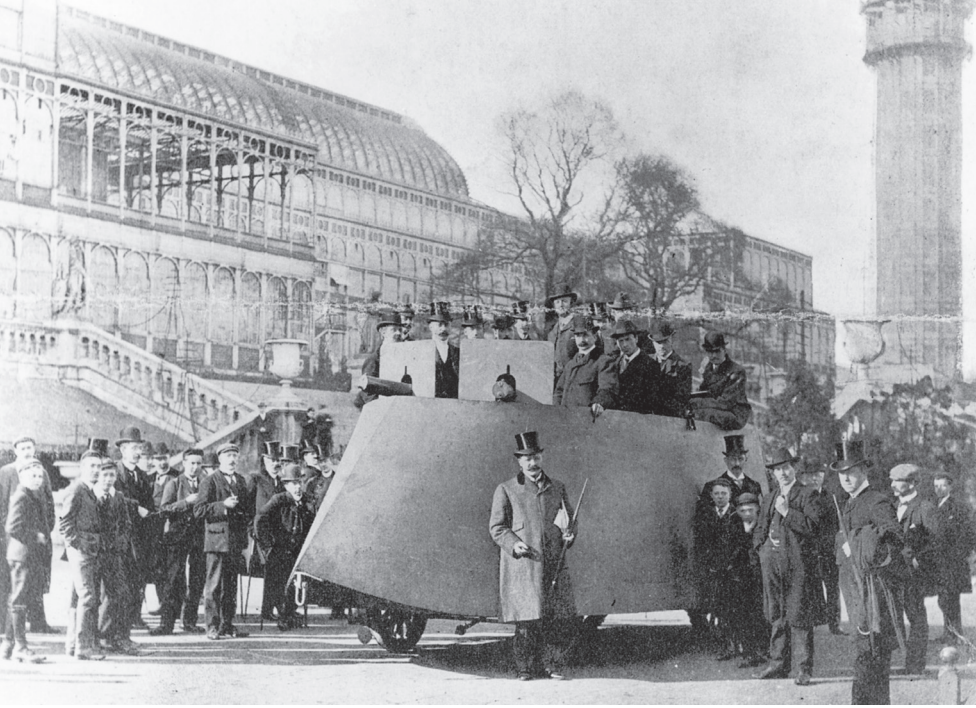
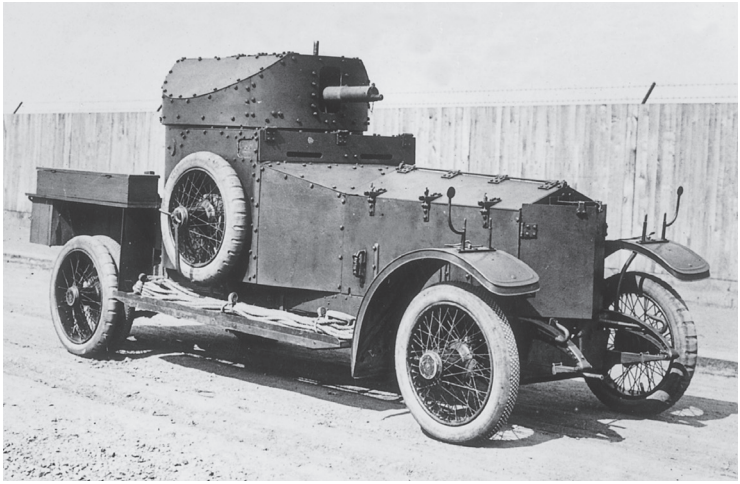


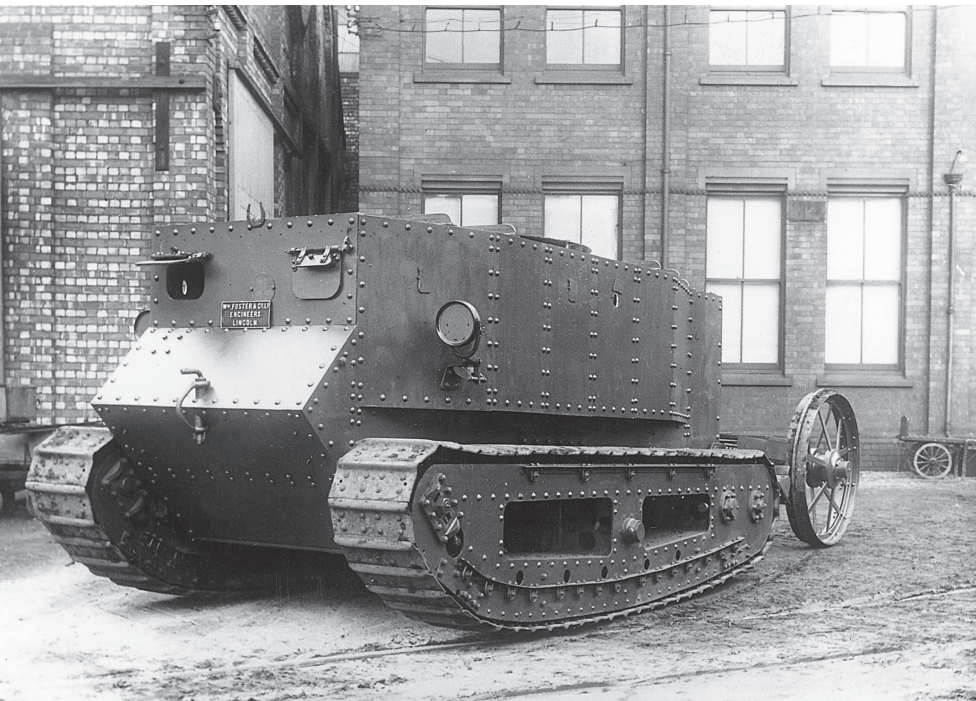
ABOVE • Simms''War Car', the first vehicle that was armed and armoured demonstrated at the Crystal Palace in London in 1902. (© ZF Friedrichshafen AG)

BELOW • Hornsby tractor during British Army trials at Aldershot in 1910. (The Tank Museum)



ABOVE • Armoured car built in 1915 on the Rolls-Royce 'Silver Ghost' chassis for the Royal Naval Air Service. (Imperial War Museum, Q 14632)

BELOW • 'Little Willie', the first tank, completed in September 1915. (© Rolls-Royce plc)

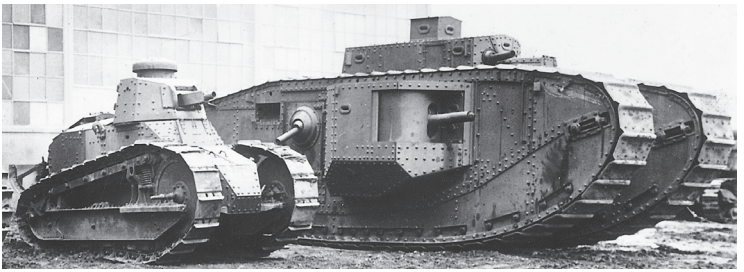


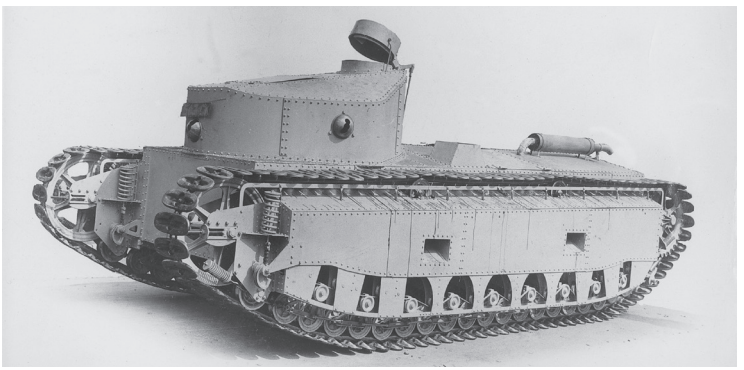
ABOVE • 'Mother', the progenitor of the rhomboidal British tanks of the First World War, at its presentation in January 1916.

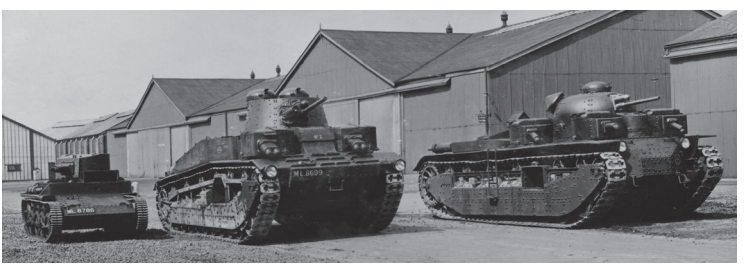
BELOW • Mark I tank during the first tank action in September 1916. (Imperial War Museum, Q 2486)

ABOVE • The first French tank built in September 1916 by the Schneider company, after which it was named. (Imperial War Museum, Q 57721)

BELOW • The French Renault FT light tank, the world's most numerous and the most widely used tank from the end of the First World War until the 1930s. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)



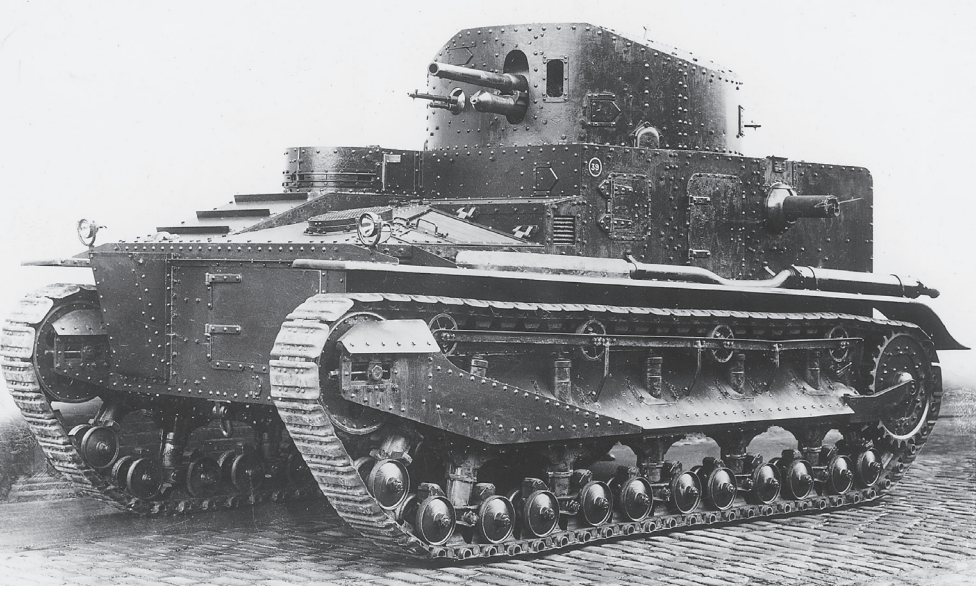




TOP • Belated products of the First World War: the US M1917 light tank, a copy of the Renault FT, and an Anglo-American Mark VIII, the last of the rhomboidal heavy tanks, both of which were retained by the US Army into the 1930s. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

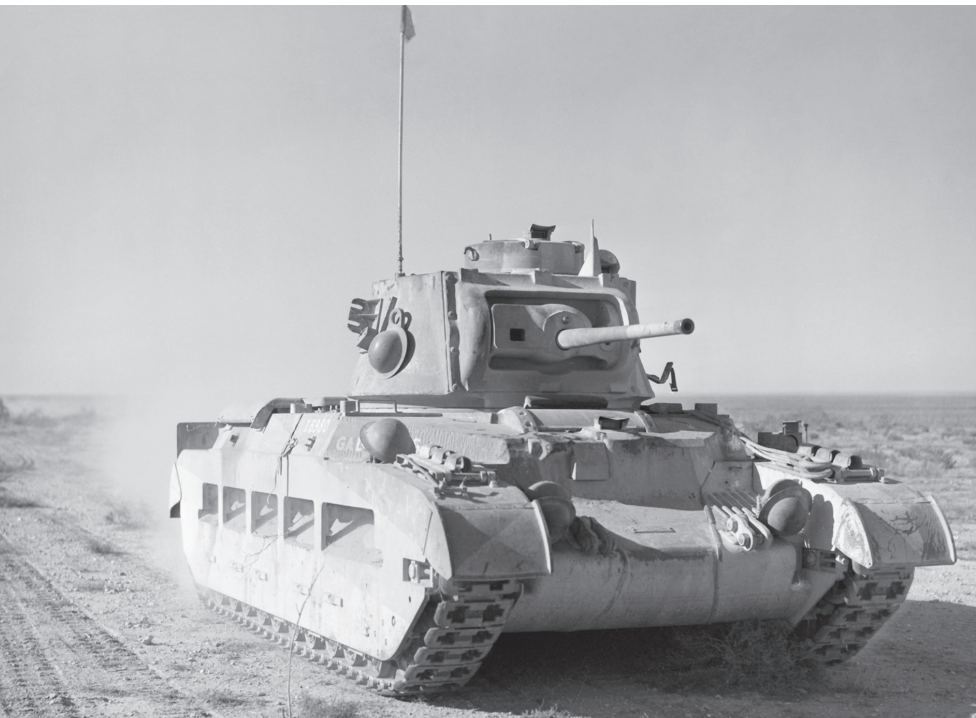
MIDDLE • The Experimental British Light Infantry Tank, which demonstrated the possibility of a considerable advance in the mobility of tanks by attaining a speed of 30mph in 1922. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

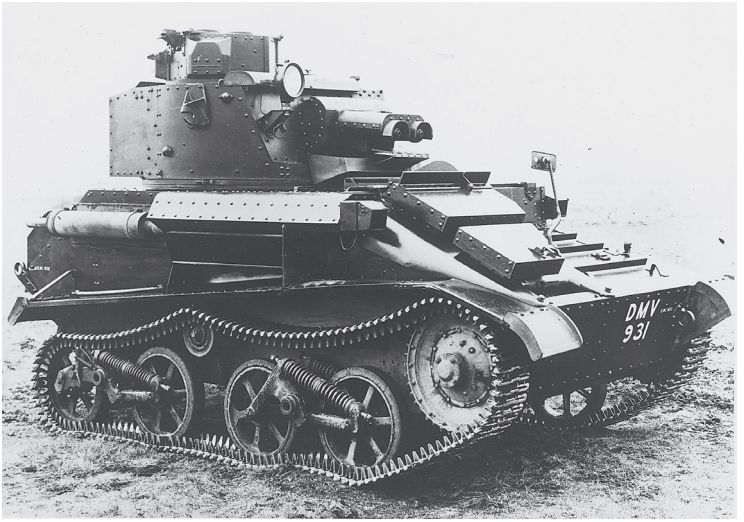
BOTTOM • Two-man Light Tank Mark I (on the left), the three-turret A.6 or Sixteen Tonner (centre) and the five-turret A.1 Independent – outstanding examples of British tank development during the late 1920s. (The Tank Museum)



ABOVE • The Vickers Medium, the only tank produced in quantity during the 1920s and more mobile than its wartime predecessors, which made it arouse greater interest in tanks worldwide. (BAE SYSTEMS)

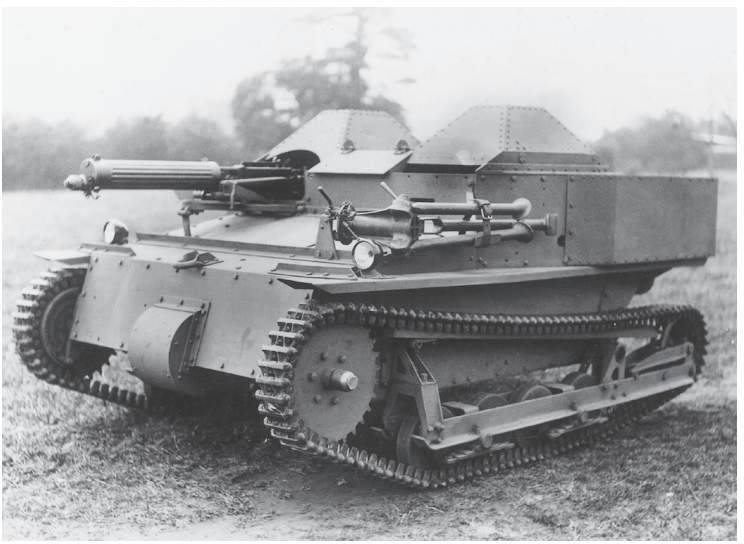
BELOW • The Matilda infantry tank, the most effective British tank in the early stages of the Second World War, due mainly to its thick armour. (Imperial War Museum, E 1416)





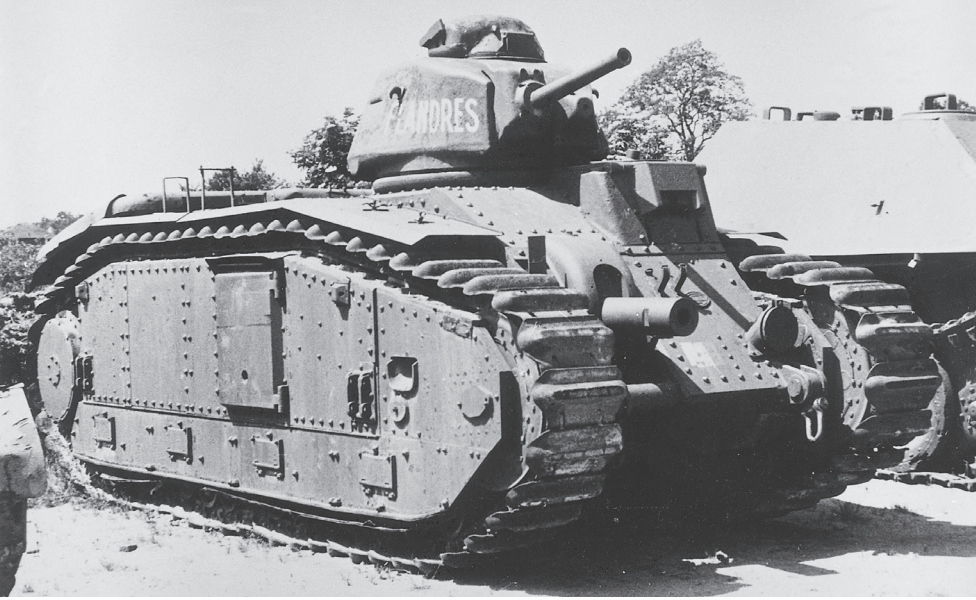
ABOVE • The Light Tank Mark VI, the principal British tank at the outbreak of the Second World War. (Imperial War Museum, MH 3582)

BELOW • The Carden Loyd Mark VI Machine Gun Carrier, which inspired the production in several countries of turretless 'tankettes' and very light two-man tanks. (BAE SYSTEMS)



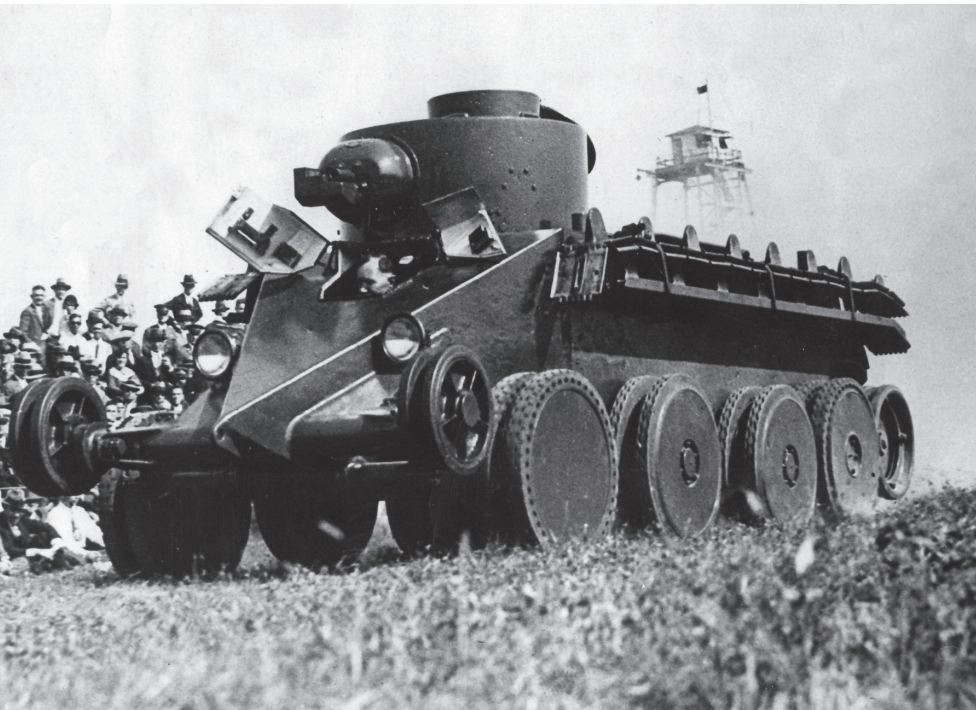
ABOVE • The Vickers Six Ton Tank, the forerunner of the light or medium tanks armed with cannon of 37 to 47mm that were typical of the late 1930s. (BAE SYSTEMS)

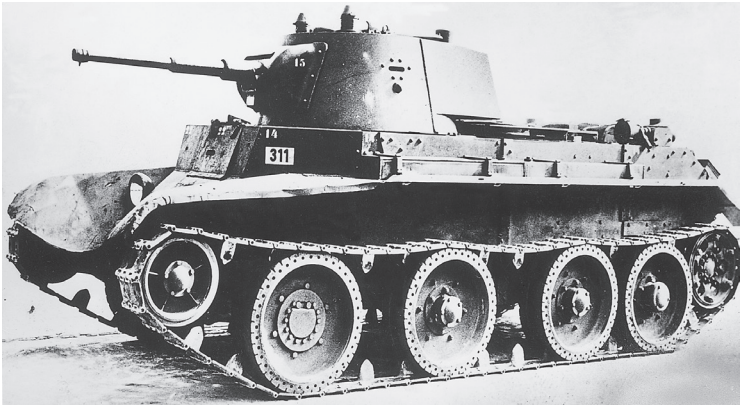
BELOW • The Renault R 35, a relatively well armoured but poorly armed light infantry tank that was the most numerous French tank in 1940. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)



ABOVE • The French Char B1 bis, one of the most powerful tanks of its day but ill-suited to mobile operations. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

BELOW • The US 'convertible' T3 Medium Tank designed by J. W. Christie, which could run on its road wheels after the removal of its tracks; on tracks it attained a maximum speed of 40mph. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

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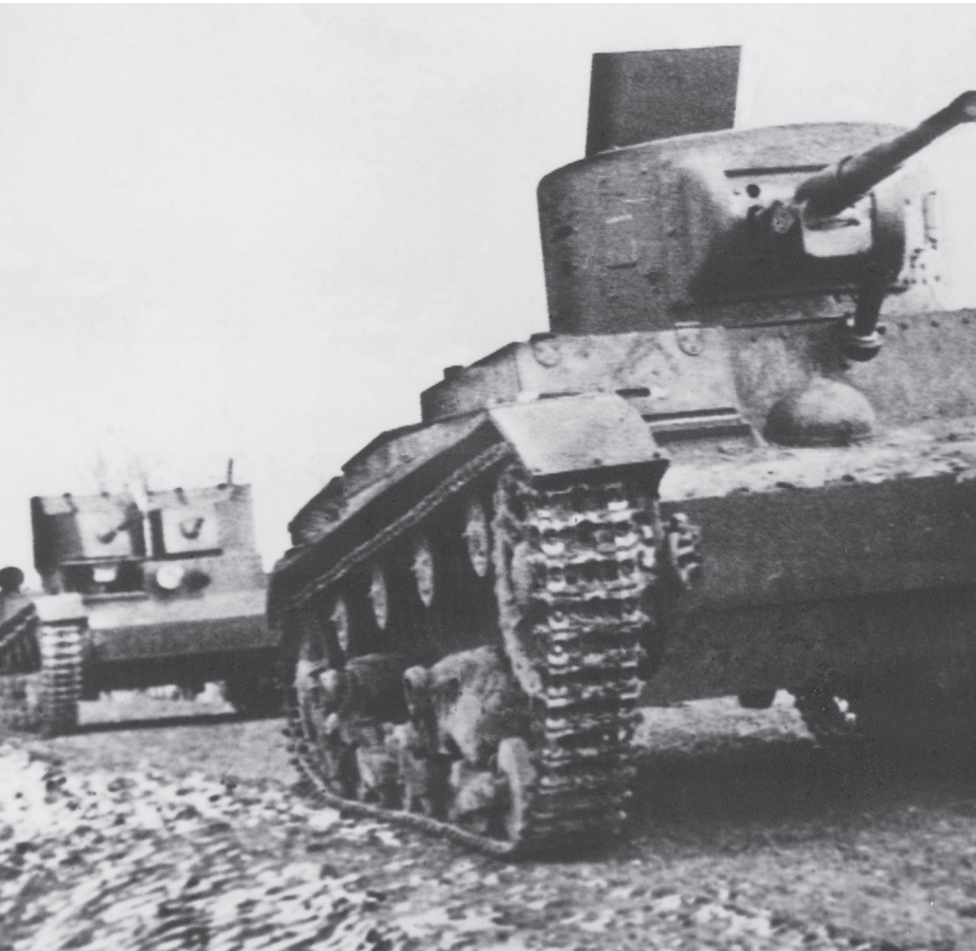
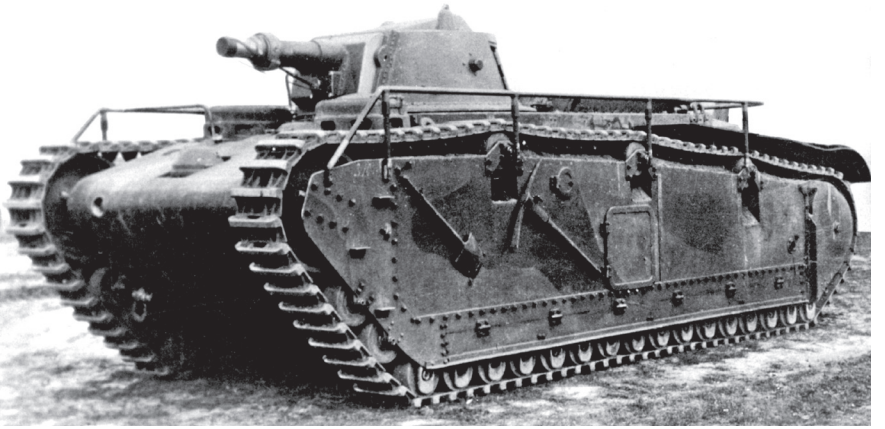


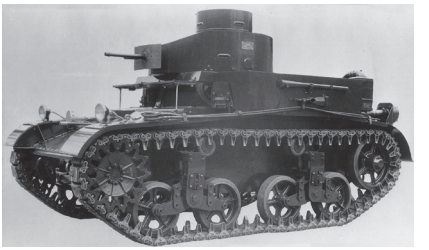


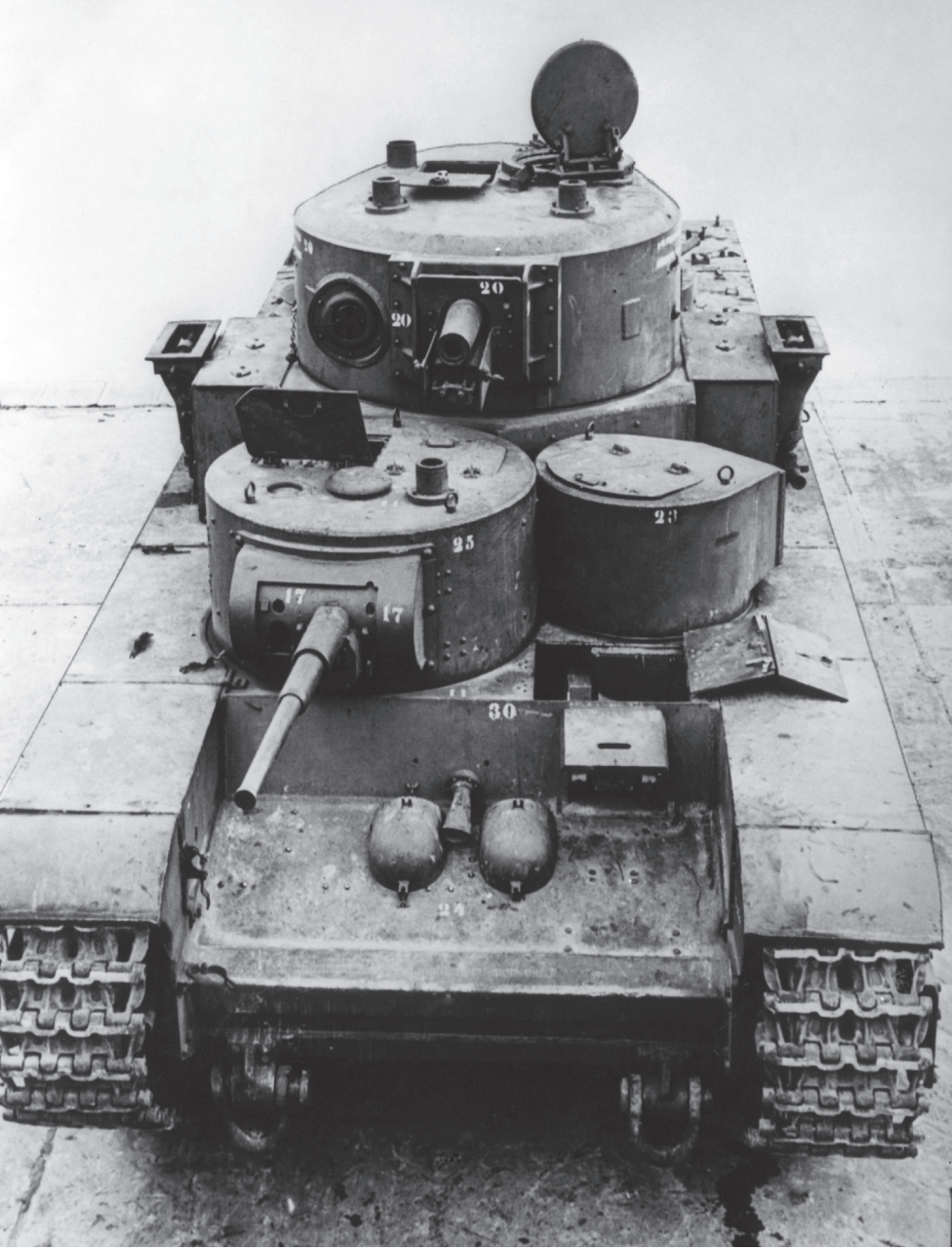
ABOVE LEFT• The Soviet BT-7, one of the series of the *bystrochodni* or fast tanks based on the medium tank developed by 1931 for the US Army by J. W. Christie. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

ABOVE RIGHT • *Grosstraktor* secretly built by Rheinmetall, the first of the medium tanks with turret-mounted 75 or 76mm guns, which became the norm during the Second World War. (Patton Museum)

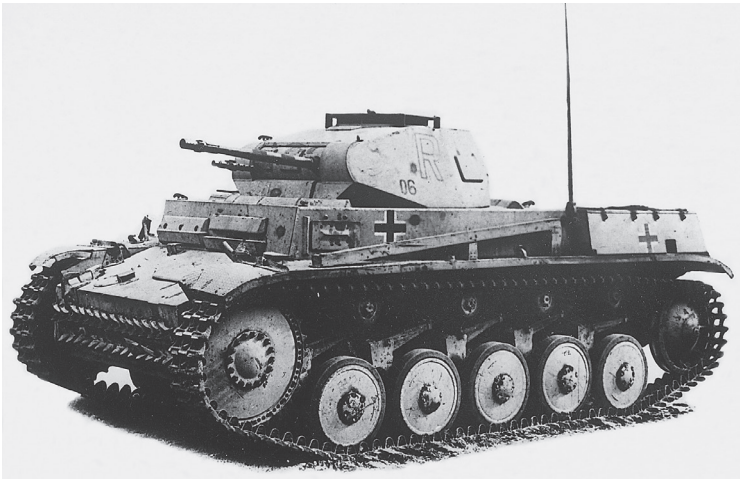
LEFT • The T-26, a Soviet copy of the Vickers Six Ton Tank, which became the most numerous tank in the world on the eve of the Second World War; in the background is an early twin turret version. (The Tank Museum)

BELOW • Progressive development of light tanks, like this M2A1, in the 1930s laid the foundations of the robust character of US tanks of the Second World War. (US Army)



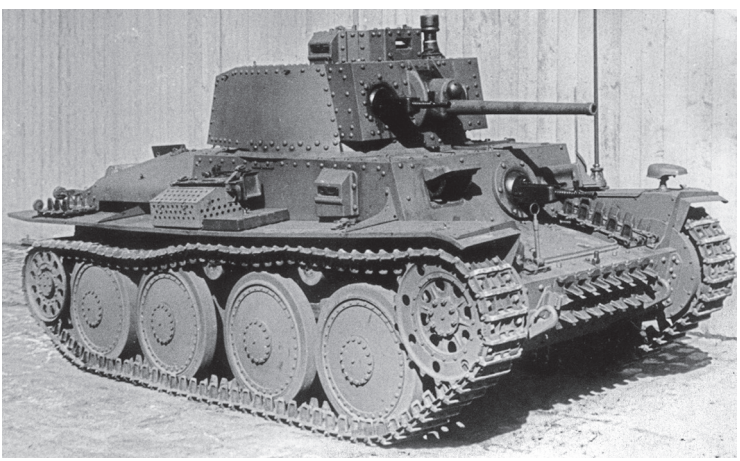


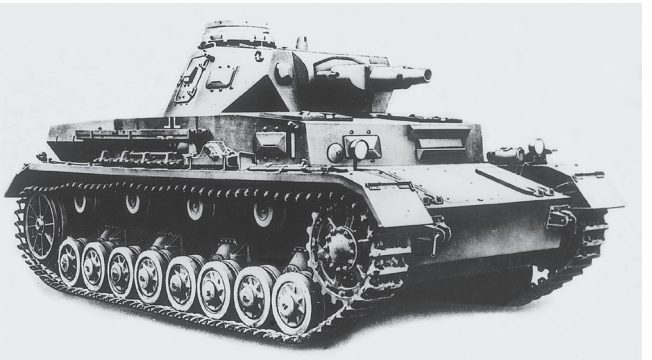
T-35 heavy tank, the extreme example of Soviet tank development before the Second World War. (Topfoto.co.uk)

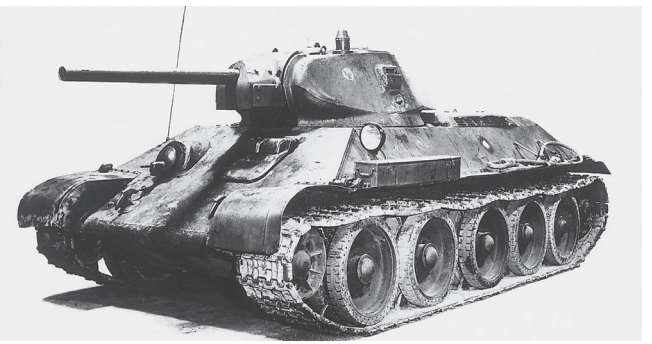


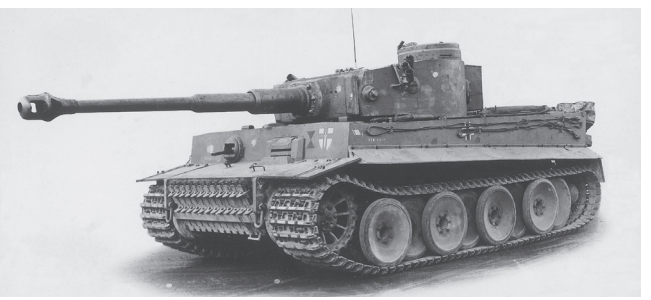
ABOVE • A PzKpfw II light three-man tank armed with a 20mm cannon, which was the most numerous German tank during the 1940 campaign in France. (Imperial War Museum, MH 4134)

BELOW • Czech-produced light tank, which as PzKpfw 38(t) formed a significant part of the German tank strength during the first three years of the Second World War.





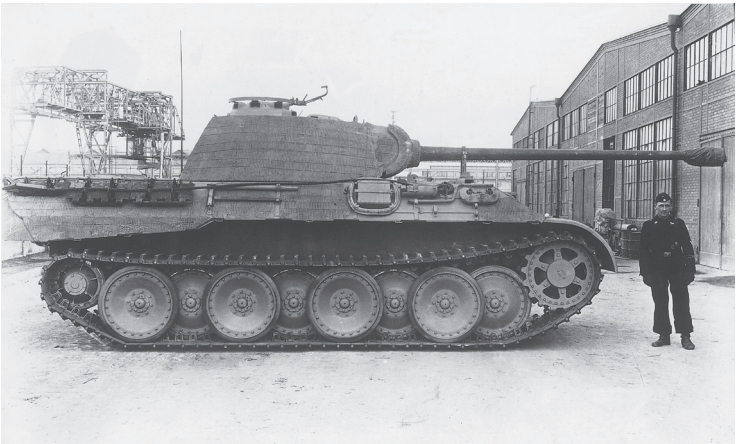




TOP • An early version of PzKpfw IV armed with a low-velocity 75mm gun, which was the most powerful German tank during the first part of the Second World War. (Imperial War Museum, MH 4227)

MIDDLE • The T-34, a tank of 26 to 31 tonnes armed with a medium-velocity 76mm gun that was the mainstay of the Soviet armoured forces during the war. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

BOTTOM • The German Tiger I heavy tank, the first to be armed with a high-velocity gun of more than 75 or 76mm calibre, which made it the most powerful tank in 1943. (Tank Museum)



ABOVE • The German Panther, widely regarded as the best medium tank of the Second World War. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

BELOW • The T-34-85, in essence the T-34 with a larger three-man turret and an 85mm gun that was produced in large numbers from the latter part of the war for the Soviet Army and the various post-war allies of the Soviet Union.

ABOVE • The *Sturmgeschutz* or assault gun, in effect a turretless tank armed with a 75mm gun that proved very effective as a mobile anti-tank weapon. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

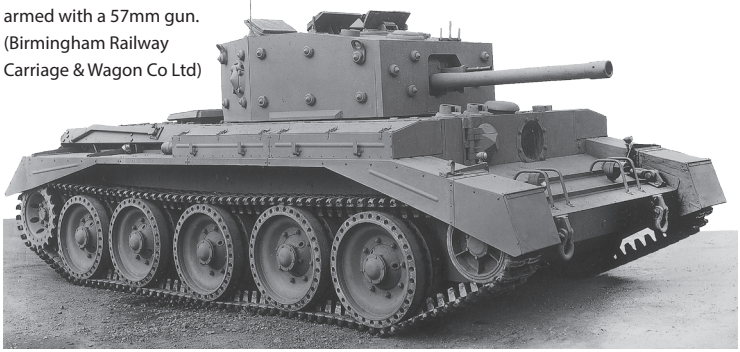
BELOW • The Valentine infantry tank, which was produced in greater numbers than any other British tank. (BAE SYSTEMS)

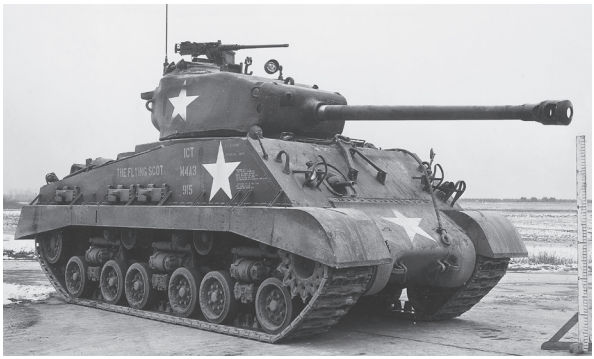
ABOVE • US-produced M3 medium tanks with the British-inspired Grant version on the left and the Lee version on the right, both armed with hull-mounted 75mm guns. (Imperial War Museum, E 14053)

BELOW • An early M4A1 version of the US Sherman medium tank armed with a medium-velocity 75mm gun. (US Army)

Tanks developed by the US Army in the 1950s: from the left, the M103 heavy tank, M48 and M47 medium tanks and the M41 light tank. (US Army)

RIGHT • A British Cromwell I cruiser tank armed with a 57mm gun. (Birmingham Railway Carriage & Wagon Co Ltd)





LEFT • A late M4A3 version of the US Sherman medium tank armed with a 76mm gun that continued to be widely used for several years after the Second World War. (US Army)

LEFT • The IS-3 (Stalin) heavy tank was first seen at the end of the Second World War. Here an IS-3 takes part in a Tank Day in the Czech Republic. (Wikipedia Commons/ Public Domain)

RIGHT • The Soviet T-62 was more than a decade ahead of other tanks in being armed with a high-velocity, smooth bore gun firing APFSDS ammunition with arrow-like penetrators. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

ABOVE • The T-54 and the very similar T-55 were the principal Soviet tanks from the 1950s onwards and the most numerous tanks ever built. (R. Fleming)

BELOW • The T-72, the most common of a series of Soviet tanks with three-man crews and automatically loaded smooth bore 125mm guns that was introduced in the 1970s. (R. Hilmes)

ABOVE • Early version of the US M60 tank – a 105 mm gun-armed development of the M48 medium tank which was the principal tank of the US Army from the 1960s until the 1990s (US Army)

BELOW • The US-German MBT-70, an advanced design incorporating an automatically loaded 152mm gun missile launcher and a three-man crew located in the turret, abandoned because of its cost. (US Army)

BELOW • The British Centurion in its final form armed with a 105mm rifled gun, which in the 1960s and 1970s became the Western world's standard tank weapon. (FVRDE, CCR)

BOTTOM • The Component Advanced Technology Test Bed, an experimental US vehicle with a 140mm gun and a turret bustle autoloader on a modified M1 tank chassis that began to be tested in 1985. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

OPPOSITE TOP • An early version of the US M1 Abrams, which became the main battle tank of the US Army in 1991. (US Army)

OPPOSITE BOTTOM • The Tank Test Bed, an experimental US tank built in the 1980s on the M1 tank chassis with a 120mm gun in an unmanned turret remotely operated by a three-man crew located in the hull.

GENERAL DYNAMICS

ABOVE • The British Chieftain, the most heavily armed and armoured of the tanks deployed by NATO in Central Europe in the 1970s and 1980s. (FVRDE, CCR)

BELOW • The Comres 75, an experimental vehicle built by the British Fighting Vehicles Research and Development Establishment in 1968 to explore the contemporary interest in tanks with guns mounted externally on pedestals. (FVRDE, CCR)

ABOVE • The FV 4211 experimental tank based on the Chieftain built in 1971 by FVRDE to demonstrate for the first time the potential effectiveness of the so-called 'Chobham armour' against shaped charge missiles and projectiles. (FVRDE, CCR)

BELOW • The Challenger I, a further development of the British Chieftain with enhanced protection incorporating explosive reactive armour, which was created for the invasion of Iraq in 2003 but was still armed with a rifled 120mm gun. (Ogorkiewicz Collection)

LEFT • French AMX 13 light tank of the early 1950s, the first to have a bustle autoloader for its gun. (French Army)

BELOW LEFT • The AMX 30, developed in the 1960s to meet a requirement for a European medium tank and armed with a 105mm gun firing special Obus G shaped charge anti-tank ammunition. (French Army)

ABOVE • The AMX Leclerc, the last of the third generation of post-Second World War tanks, manned by a crew of three and armed with an automatically loaded smooth bore 120mm gun. (GIAT Industries)

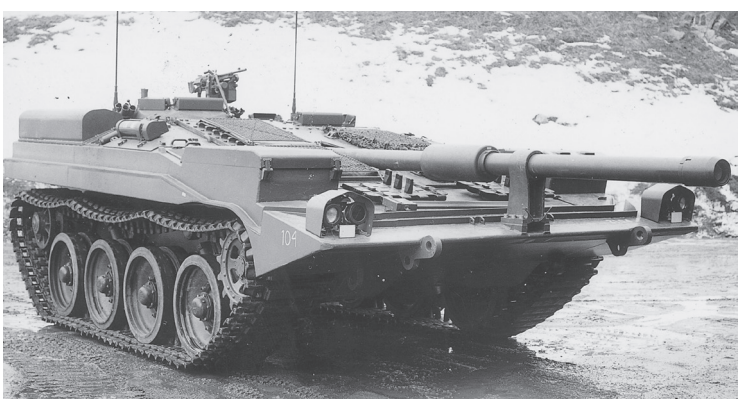
MAIN • The German Leopard 1, designed to the same requirement as the French AMX 30 but armed with the British 105mm L7 gun. It was highly regarded for its mobility.

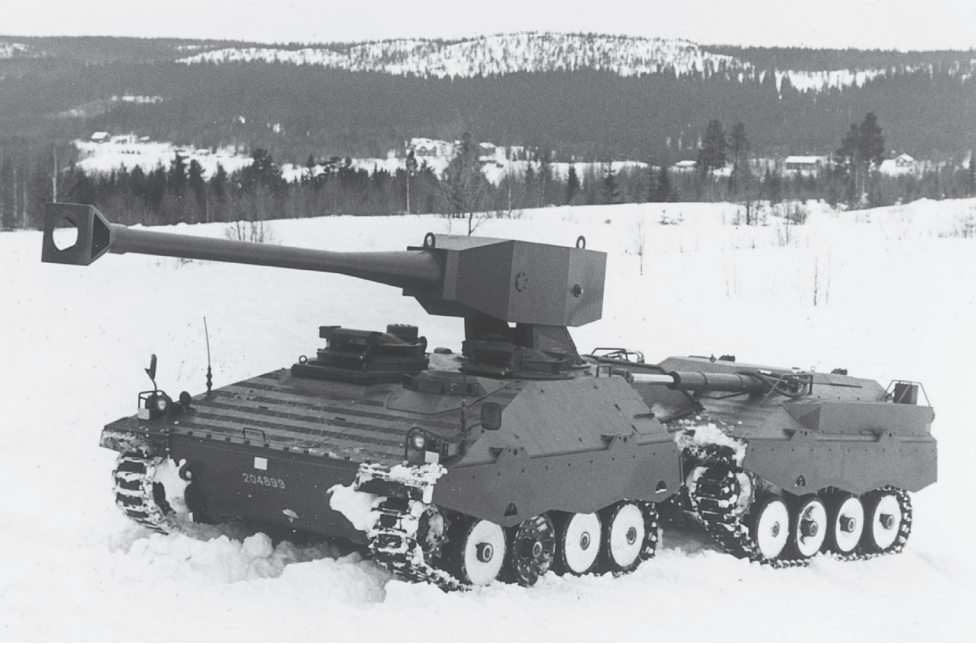
ABOVE • The experimental German VT 1-2 turretless tank with two 120mm guns that could fire salvoes to increase the probability of hitting a target.

BELOW • The Leopard 2, a more heavily armoured follow-on to the Leopard 1, adopted by the German Army in 1979 and armed with the then new Rheinmetall 120mm smooth bore gun. It was subsequently also adopted by 14 other armies worldwide.

ABOVE • The Swiss Pz.68, a rare example of a battle tank with a hull cast in one piece. (Swiss Army)

BELOW • A turretless Swedish S-tank armed with an automatically loaded 105mm gun. It is the only tank ever built that could be fully operated by one man instead of its normal crew of three. (BAE SYSTEMS)

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